illegally hunting on Aussie ground. When the Australian intelligence operatives were unleashed on them, the Fijian soldiers disappeared. The Indian agents believed they had been neutralised before they could escape to Suva.

'The strongest emotion I have is the living pain of betrayal,' Kailash had told Shekhawat and other officials who were concerned about the future of the Fiji operation.

'You cannot separate spying and deceit; they complement each other,' Shekhawat recalled telling Kailash and Sahgal when they made atrip to India in September 1989.

That was a tumultuous period. Rabuka, facing bad press in the international media due to the R&AW campaign, had appointed a Constitutional Inquiry and Advisory Committee to review the draft constitution of Fiji that discriminated against Indians. The exercise, though, was a smokescreen. The deposed government of Timoci Bavadra had submitted a memorandum before the committee requesting it to weed out provisions which were retrograde, unfair, discriminatory and unjustifiable taking into account the legitimate concerns and aspirations of all sections of the people of Fiji. On 21 September 1989, the Indian MEA said:

Reports from Suva indicate that the Constitutional Inquiry and Advisory Committee has not addressed itself to the Central issue of insisting on establishing Constitutional provisions, which are just, fair, equitable and racially non-discriminatory. It is the hope and expectation of the government that all responsible members of the Fijian society will continue to work for a genuine and constructive dialogue amongst themselves, for this alone can ultimately ensure peace, stability and racial harmony in the troubled Islands of Fiji.